

JOSE ANTONIO ELIZALDE

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Education

University of California, Los Angeles

Sept 2025 – June 2027

B.S. in Computer Science and Engineering

Westwood, CA

Technical Skills

Engines & Tools: Unity, Blender, Git/GitHub, Visual Studio, Vim/NeoVim

Languages: C#, C++, C, Python

Gameplay: character controllers, physics and collision, ability/card systems, state machines, UI and dialogue systems

Production: game direction, scope and milestone planning, Git branching and pull-request review, playtest iteration

Coursework: Data Structures and Algorithms, Object-Oriented C++, Computer Architecture, Discrete Mathematics, Physics

Experience

UCLA ACM Studio (SRS) – Student-Run Studio

Oct 2024 – Present

Game Director, Jump the Gun; Gameplay Programmer, Cloudy Critters

Los Angeles, CA

- Direct a multi-person team on a first-person action shooter, owning the design direction and coordinating implementation across programmers, artists and designers.
- Ship gameplay on a second title in parallel, *Cloudy Critters*, a city-builder/deck-builder roguelike tycoon being prepared for a Steam release.
- Run both teams on Git branching and pull requests so multiple contributors can land gameplay features concurrently without blocking each other.

Game Projects

Jump the Gun | Unity, C#, HLSL/ShaderLab, Git – Game Director

Oct 2024 – Present

- Lead design and development of a single-player first-person action shooter built around fast, close-range combat, defining the gameplay mechanics and coordinating implementation across the team.
- Wrote the custom physics-based movement controller in C#, replacing Unity's built-in character controller with hand-written movement and collision logic so the game's feel is authored rather than inherited from the engine default.
- Maintain the team's Git branching and pull-request workflow, reviewing and integrating gameplay features developed concurrently by multiple contributors.

Cloudy Critters | Unity, C#, Blender – Gameplay Programmer

2026 – Present

- Currently working on a city-builder/deck-builder roguelike tycoon in which the player constructs a sky zoo and has to clear a quota measured against the points their animal enclosures generate.
- Working on the card ability system so I am implementing individual card effects and the rules by which they resolve against the player's enclosures.
- Implementing the main gameplay loop mechanics that tie building, scoring and the quota check together into a run.
- Modeling the animals and habitats in Blender and bringing them into Unity as game-ready assets, covering both the gameplay code and the 3D content it drives.

Shellscape | Unity, C#, WebGL – Game Programmer, team of 5

Aug 2026

- Shipped a browser-playable action game with a team of five UCLA students, designed and completed inside a game jam window, placing 74th out of roughly 150 teams, and released publicly on itch.io.
- Implemented the movement and interaction systems, including the body-possession mechanic the whole game is built around: the player has no shell of their own and takes over enemy bodies to borrow their weapons.
- Built the tutorial scene, including the scripted narration and dialogue box system that teaches the possession mechanic.

Research Experience

Carnegie Mellon University – REUSE Research Program

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Undergraduate Researcher, Human-Computer Interaction Institute (HCII)

Pittsburgh, PA

- Built an interactive application studying whether gamified in-ride interactions can improve communication and empathy between rideshare drivers and passengers, refining its features from usability testing across nine workshops.
- Co-authored *Beyond Riding: Passenger Engagement with Driver Labor through Gamified Interactions*, accepted to CHI 2026 (ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, Barcelona).

University of California, Los Angeles – SURE C² Research Program

June 2024 – Aug 2024

Undergraduate Researcher, Department of Mathematics

Los Angeles, CA

- Wrote a C++ program to enumerate all transfer systems of a given finite poset, automating a count that grows exponentially with the cardinality of the set, and discovered a recursive relationship for the family of sets X_n^{++} that contributed to a co-authored paper.